role of education in defining the meaning of citizenship. Given that the sample focused on students, studying in either schools or universities, the majority of the participants believed that the education system was instrumental in defining their meaning and understanding of citizenship in Pakistan. For a nineteen-year-old female in Hub, education '*played a great role in determining the conception of citizenship*' developing '*discipline and self-control in one's life*', providing a sense of organization to one's life, and teaching the '*difference between good and bad*' (Student, Female, Hub). Education was also instrumental in making students both '*aware*' of their '*history*' and take '*pride*' in their identity (Teacher, Female, Karachi), while motivating them '*to do something for*' their '*country*'. '*As a "Pakistani" we must strive to make Pakistan a better place and to contribute to its well-being*' (Student, Female, Lahore). This sense of responsibility towards Pakistan was for many students a result of their education system, but the question that arises is what does it mean to be a Pakistani citizen for young Pakistanis today? This is especially important to explore in a context where the education system propagates Islamic nationalism as the defining feature of being Pakistani.

The meaning of citizenship for most is linked to an uncritical notion of nationalism and loyalty to an Islamic Republic, with limited understanding of civic duties and responsibilities. Given what is promoted through textbooks in schools, it was not surprising to find students from government schools or universities highlight the importance of Islam for their Pakistani identity. However, this was also true for the majority of students belonging to private sector universities and schools, especially private universities catering to the more privileged sections of society in Lahore and Karachi, where only a small percentage of students questioned the possibility of an alternative history and the place of religion in defining their Pakistani identity. The overall responses of participants were predominantly divided into citizenship as linked with nationalism and Islam, as anti-Indian or a sentiment that connected them to the sacrifices of their forefathers. However, these responses were not mutually exclusive, but were rather interconnected thereby reinforcing the Pakistani-Muslim connection. For those who were critical of the notion of citizenship, the criticism for the majority of the students was linked to the inability of Pakistanis, especially the Pakistani state, to practice Islam in its 'true' sense. Answers to the question of what is the 'true' sense of Islam in relation to Pakistan also varied; teachers belonging to the Islamic Studies department of a government sector university in Lahore proposed 'true Islam' to be defined by a scholar whose interpretations Muslims agree to follow, while for others 'true' Islam was linked with honesty and lack of corruption. However, as discussed in this section, the